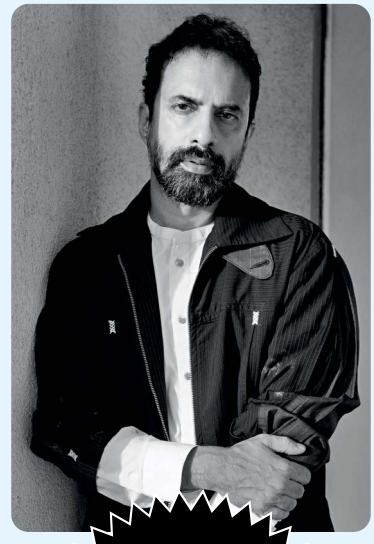
MUSIC ▼

Ode to Unproductivity

MUSICIAN **ANKUR TEWARI**'S NEW ALBUM, *MR. FAARIGH*, IS A CALL TO SLOW DOWN AMIDST THE CONSTANT NEED TO STAY OCCUPIED

Following his 2023 release *Akela*, which reflected on the pandemic, singer-songwriter Ankur Tewari found himself caught in the post-COVID rush, fixated on constant productivity. His new nine-track *Mr. Faarigh* directly confronts this urban anxiety. Derived from Urdu, 'faarigh' means to be free, idle or unoccupied—a state Tewari felt he had lost. "I see hope in just being and not trying to prove something to yourself or to the world," says Tewari.

Born out of the vacuum that followed a massive project, the record embraces human imperfection. The audio deliberately retains white noise and background chatter to capture an unpolished, organic aesthetic. From songs about anxiety and calendar obligations to drunk dialling and rage, the album explores the underlying triggers of our productivity obsession. Tewari's songwriting process remains intensely personal. "When you feel something intensely, that guides the song. You start having a conversation with the voices in your head."

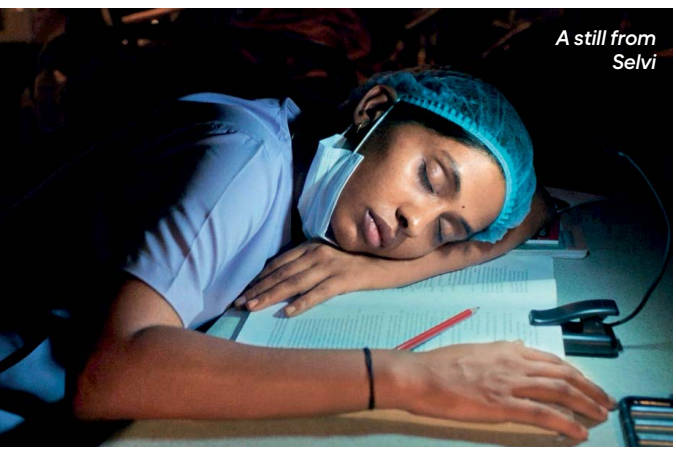


"I see hope in just being and not trying to prove something to yourself or to the world"
—Ankur Tewari

Fans can experience these stories live as Tewari embarks on a tour with his band, stopping in Mumbai, Pune, Delhi, Ladakh, three shows in Venice as part of the Serendipity Arts Festival, followed by Bengaluru. "I am also co-curating the Serendipity Arts Festival in Goa at the end of the year. Before that, I plan to finish a single or two," he shares. ■

—Deepali Dhingra

Upcoming concert dates: ***Sept. 4*** *(Delhi),* ***Sept. 6*** *(Ladakh) and* ***Sept. 19*** *(Bengaluru)*



A still from Selvi

"I WAS AWKWARD WITH THE WHOLE SHEBANG OF BEING AN ACTOR," SAYS PATIL. "THE FIRST INCLINATION WAS WRITING AND DIRECTION"

the opportunities she wanted. Five years back, Patil set up Anahat Films. After producing a documentary (*Neither Girl Nor a Woman*), shorts and two features, Patil produces and stars in Tamil drama *Selvi*, which will have its world premiere at the Busan International Film Festival in October.

A graduate of drama from Pune University and theatre design and direction from the National School of Drama, Patil calls herself "an accidental actor". "I felt awkward and never associated with the whole shebang of being an actor," she says. "The first inclination was always writing and direction." Her creative instinct would take her to the NFDC Film Bazaar in Goa in 2022 where she'd meet filmmaker Sailesh Rathnakumar and cinematographer Bargav Sridhar, friends who had written a drama following the hectic routine of a homecare nurse. So the titular part of Selvi was born.

Selvi continues Patil's penchant for characters which live on the margins. Patil calls it more a "subconscious and artistic choice" than a calculated move. *Selvi* also continues the Nashik-born Patil's fascinating journey with Tamil-language films, which started with Rajinikanth-starrer Kaala and included acclaimed Sri Lankan drama *With You, Without You*. Says Patil, "The amount of love I have received [in Chennai] is incredible. It's the gentleness and generosity of people."

Having understood "the rules of the industry", Patil is going a step further to direct her first feature: a feminist sci-fi script, already written by her. ■

—Suhani Singh